(Congress legislator from Muvattupuzha), Kodikunnal Suresh (Lok Sabha Member of Parliament) and other Congress leaders who helped civil society make arrangements.

The third challenge we faced was getting civil society yatris to campsites for meals. This posed distinct challenges, because the security personnel changed every few kilometres. Consequently, they didn't recognize us at different camps, and the Yatra's leadership would get busy with the afternoon interactions. We temporarily resolved this by individually taking civil society yatris into the camps. This often meant that we all skipped lunch because we had to wait for a couple of hours until all civil society yatris had come in. But we all impressed upon Digvijaya Singh that we had to make separate passes that would enable them to enter the camps. Thankfully that problem was resolved soon after.

Learning from the experiences in Tamil Nadu and Kerala, the Congress party stepped in after Kerala to provide support to our team for civil society. In Karnataka, senior Congress leader B.K. Hariprasad, Sasikanth Senthil (former IAS) and Zubair went out of their way to aid us; in Andhra Pradesh, K. Raju (AICC in-charge for the SC–ST–OBC–Minority departments), K. Suresh (secretary of the Pradesh Congress Committee) and Dr Ravi Nayak looked after arrangements for civil society; Madhu Yakshi Gaud (former MP) did so in Telangana; while in Maharashtra, Balasaheb Thorat (Congress Legislative Party leader in the assembly), Ashok Chavan (former chief minister) and Mohan Joshi (member of the legislative assembly) looked after us; Meenakshi Natarajan (former MP) in Madhya Pradesh; Rafiq (MLA) in Rajasthan; and Parpreet Brar (Mahila Congress vice president) in Punjab helped our team look after civil society by promptly arranging vehicles, buses for luggage, accommodation in special camps (titled Camp 2, specially for civil society yatris) or in alternative comfortable areas, which included food, bathing facilities, mobile toilets and other necessary arrangements. My burdens were further eased with the joining of Amrit Singh from SBF, who assisted me until the Telangana stretch of the Yatra.